

Critical Reflection on Post-Structuralism as of Wednesday, 17 August 2022.
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It's pretty impossible for me to look at a Grand Monument as anything but a colonial imposition. This is skewed towards a white straight man's perspective. But while I have no idea what structuralism/post-structuralism is, I do greatly appreciate the focus on the semiotic.

The idea of the perceiver/the observer and the creator/engineer, the giver and the taker. That which presents and that which observes. It's a very interesting concept that the two exist at the same time. We strive to create things in human nature that sit in the tension of duality. That's where things are often the most profound.

Examining the series of habitations scattered among the levels of the tower, it becomes clear that humans really push the boundaries of what is possible: we integrate the mundane with the extraordinary. It's just astounding.

Sitting at a restaurant in a purely structural form is like sitting on a ribcage. There's something incredibly poetic about that.

A structure itself has created poetry, and at the same time, used scale and perspective to create a paradox. It's become a symbol that evokes emotion-culture-response.

A monument is basically an artwork on a larger scale that does not have function (is meaningless) but can never be a singularity in terms of meaning.

I do think that the Eiffel Tower is indeed very special. It's there as a symbol, but it's there as a thing to be traversed. It's there simply to exact upon the individual a journey - a type of installation.

Humans challenge levels, we strive towards the skies - to see things from the perspective of creation - topography of land that is so invariably larger than oneself.

However, landmarks often perpetuate barriers. It suggests an exclusive experience, cultural initiation only to those who can afford it.

They are a mark of tourism, not of travel, not of culture, not of people, not of the small scale interventions that make a city living. The mention of the staircase in particular on the Eiffel Tower makes me think about the principle of stairs.

Symbolism and locale isn't always grand, and over-romanticising certain landmarks prevents us from seeing the beauty in small things.

Stairs are symbols or icons, they're a universal signifier.

The world is too diverse for grand gestures. My generation doesn't seek big, we seek small. Stairs. It's a structural object itself. It implies movement. It is a microcosm of a space that encapsulates the way we are supposed to move through it. visibility and viewpoint depends on where you are standing.

Looking at photographs, something is there because it's frozen in time: only exists in that moment, and then it doesn't exist anymore. Similarly, a landmark is holding an immeasurable amount of history that cannot be perceived in anything but that moment, and then it's gone. It's fleeting.

When you're looking at something that doesn't exist, you can have a reference point as the observer. And you are the creator of a moment that is infinite, and at the same time non-existent.

Post-lecture I now realize that my entire stance and my entire position regarding the Eiffel Tower is in itself proving the point of the article which I find absolutely amazing, which is that the meaning and interpretation of this tower is countless meaningless by definition of its infinity, but still that which evokes response and so it is a timeless signifier. And what I love is that I am being forced to live in a space that is uncomfortable because it has no clear definition and that's what I love doing as a fan of deconstruction. So it's interesting to see how objects places things. Language can exist as an entity, in between two binaries that are ever-evolving.